



SEASONAL CARE TIPS

Mid-season care to help your plants stay *productive and beautiful* through the hottest months.

Why deadhead or prune?

- Encourages new blooms and bushier growth.
- Directs plant energy to healthy foliage and roots.
- Reduces disease by improving air circulation.



Deadheading 101.

Remove spent flowers to promote continuous blooming.

Plant type	Deadhead?	How-to
Annuals	Yes—often	Pinch or snip just below flower stem
Perennials	Selectively	Cut faded blooms back to leaf or node
Flowering shrubs	Sometimes	Prune lightly after bloom cycle

Avoid damaging emerging buds or leaf nodes.



Pruning in summer.

Tool tip: use sanitized pruners or snips; clean with rubbing alcohol between cuts to prevent disease.

- Light shaping: Remove stray or unruly branches.
- Thinning: Improve airflow in dense growth (roses, herbs).
- Pinching: Encourage bushier herbs or annuals.
- Cut just above a node or branching point—this tells the plant where to regrow.

Mid-season plant check-in.

Sign	What it means	What to do
Pale/yellow leaves	Nutrient deficiency	Feed with balanced fertilizer
Leggy growth	Not enough sun or pruning	Pinch/prune and move if needed
Powdery mildew	Too much moisture or crowding	Improve air flow, treat organically
Slow blooming	Spent blooms or tired roots	Deadhead and refresh soil or fertilize

Mid-summer boosts.

- Fertilize containers and annual beds every 2-4 weeks.
- Use liquid organic fertilizer for quick absorption.
- Try foliar feeding in early morning for fast nutrient uptake.
- Refresh mulch and top off soil as needed.

Homestead summer toolkit:

- Fiskars® and Corona hand pruners
- Espoma® Flower-tone® and organic liquid fertilizers
- Seaweed/kelp foliar sprays
- Sharpeners, gloves, and folding saws

Keep your garden thriving.

Join us for hands-on pruning demos and plant health workshops!

Find tools, products, and expert advice all season long in-store or online: homesteadgardens.com.

